Some Heavy Lifting

The measures these two ministries take will have a direct bearing on India Inc's production capacity and global competitiveness

By M.G. ARUN

The heavy industries ministry plays a critical role in fostering domestic manufacturing and industrial growth. One of its biggest components is the automotive industry. Exports in the sector fell 5.5 per cent in FY24, due to the slowdown in several advanced markets. The industry has already been asked to make a comprehensive plan for the first 100 days of Modi 3.0.

Other sectors under the ministry's purview, like heavy engineering equipment, machine tools and heavy electrical equipment, can likewise turbo-boost domestic manufacturing and exports. In steel, the threat of rising cheaper imports refuses to go away. The production-linked incentive scheme of the government is expected to incentivise production of domestic raw material, which the government hopes will meet demand by the end of the year. However extraordinary results require extraordinary effort, and that is the challenge the ministry has to rise to. ■

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

MAKE IN INDIA This will reduce import dependence. Here, the ministry has to evaluate how PSUs fare and whether they need to work with the private sector

BOOST PRODUCTION The steel ministry has to find ways to make India a major exporter. The National Steel Policy, 2017 set an ambitious goal to have a steel capacity of 300 MT by 2030-31. In 2023, it was 160 MT

GREEN STEEL Since the EU's 12 per cent border tax on Indian steel and iron is coming into effect from 2026, domestic players have to implement sustainable production techniques. The Centre should thus incentivise end-users to use green steel

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↘ **Back in NDA** Son of former PM H.D. Deve Gowda, Kumaraswamy is president of Janata Dal (Secular) and has joined hands with the BJP for the second time

↘ **Central foray** A former Karnataka CM, he entered the Lok Sabha from Mandya and makes his debut as a central minister



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↘ **Rising through the ranks** A grassroots BJP leader from Andhra Pradesh, Varma got elected from Narasapuram Lok Sabha constituency